only by retaining your birthright to be a person. And to retain this right, you wil have to be wil ing to take the social or external risks involved in ignoring pressures to do things the way others say they should be done. What wil you cal Sivasubramania Iyer inviting me to have lunch in his kitchen? Zohara, my sister, mortgaging her gold bangles and chains to get me into engineering col ege? Prof. Sponder insisting that I should sit with him in the front row for the group photograph? Making a hovercraft in a motor-garage setup? Sudhakar's courage? Dr Brahm Prakash's support? Narayanan's management? Venkataraman's vision? Arunachalam's drive? Each is an example of a strong inner strength and initiative. As Pythagoras had said twenty-five centuries ago, "Above al things, reverence yourself."

I am not a philosopher. I am only a man of technology. I spent al my life learning rocketry. But as I have worked with a very large crosssection of people in different organizations, I had an opportunity to understand the phenomenon of professional life in its bewildering complexity. When I look back upon what I have narrated so far, my own observations and conclusions appear as